

GENDER



BENDERS

Vipra Guneta v/s Rahul Jindal

Hiding All The Desktop Icons



Rahul, a law student, is confident and raring to go. First, he right-clicks the desktop, and opens the 'Display Properties' dialog box. Under the 'Desktop' and 'Appearance' headings, Rahul hunts for an option that will enable him to conceal all the desktop icons. Not finding any solution there, he performs a series of rapid right-clicks on the desktop. Soon enough, he deselects the 'Show All Icons' option. Well done Rahul - just a tad late!



A collegian, Vipra looks very much at ease. She goes to the Start Menu, then 'Programs', and enters the Control Panel. Next, she clicks the 'Display' icon, upon which the 'Display Properties' dialog box comes into view. After clicking the numerous options to no avail, she exits the Control Panel. Vipra remains undaunted, and finally right-clicks the desktop, goes to 'Arrange Icons By', and deselects the option 'Show All Icons'. Voilà, the desktop is icon-free, and Vipra smiles serenely.

your wrists trying to hold the PSP at just the right viewing angle for hours. Launched in June, it costs about \$70 (Rs 3,050).

PowerPlay 5.1 Media Chair:

Empower Technologies PowerPlay 5.1 Media Chair will make you hate your office desk. As the name suggests, the chair is the centre of a surround sound stereo system that'll make those shots fired in *Doom 3*

pierce your heart! The setup is a prototype, and the black and tubular metal piece of furniture is unlikely to be seen anywhere but in the most macho of bachelor pads.

Logitech Cordless:

Precision/Attack Controller Gaming consoles with wireless controls is old news. Now two new offerings from Logitech bring the affordable freedom of wire-free



gaming to the PlayStation 2 and Xbox. The semi-translucent blue \$30 (Rs 1,300) Precision is compatible with the PS2, while the see-through green \$40 (Rs 1,740) Attack works with the Xbox. So what's new about the old news? Logitech says the Precision and Attack will last 300 hours on just two AA batteries.

Saitek Pro Gamer Command Pad:

This \$40 (Rs 1,740) keyboard ad-on will appeal to all the fans of first-person shooters, or any computer game where you'll need a nimble keyboard to get around. The accessory looks like a separate numeric keypad with a special thumb rest however calculating is not what Saitek have in mind when they designed this toy. The keys are laser-etched and glow blue, which should make it easier to see what keys are being frantically pounded during those intense, late-night *Doom 3* battles.

SMALL GETS SMALLER**Nanotech Gets Real**

Engineers from Canada have created the world's smallest transistor in which electricity flows through a molecule.

The device, which is visible only through a powerful microscope, may be the biggest development in nanotechnology so far.

"It's a big step forward. It could never have been

said before with certainty that a molecule could be a building block and now there's no doubt," Robert Wolkow, head of the research team at the University of Alberta, said. The team's results have appeared in the scientific journal *Nature*.

Wolkow's gizmo consists of one to 20 molecules anchored to a silicon wafer, and is nearly a thousand times smaller than conventional transistors—and requires about a millionth as much energy.

The breakthrough is the result of five years of intense work by Wolkow and his colleagues. It took this long to figure out how to line up the molecules and the small electrodes and control the flow of electricity.

However, consumers won't find this microscopic transistor in their desktops any time soon as it takes several minutes to turn the processor on or off. To be useful in a PC, it would need to make the switch in less than a microsecond.

NOW, PREMIUM PACKAGES**More To Skype About**

Skype, the much talked about VoIP provider on the Internet today, has announced two premium services. Currently, the software lets Internet users call one another for free anywhere in the world and works on the P2P model.

The premium packages—SkypeIn and Skype Voicemail—are built into the latest version of the software, available for the Linux, Mac OS, Pocket PC and Windows.

Pentium D

The Pentium D, the currently most-talked-about processor by Intel, is a dual-core processor for use mainly in desktop PCs. The Pentium D does not support HyperThreading.

Complete with hardware DRM capabilities, the new chip helps add support for surround-

sound audio, high definition video and enhanced graphics. At the bottom of the pile is the Pentium D 820, which runs at 2.8 GHz. Next up is 830 at 3.0 GHz, and then there's the 840, running at 3.2GHz. As an indicator, the PD 830 retails for \$316 (Rs 13,750).

Buzzword
of the MONTH